

11.6. Retrieving data from a table

We have learnt about adding information to a database. There are certain set strategies to recover inserted information from a database. You can use 'mysql_query ()' to make a select query. Suppose you have a record in your database and you want to output it. The first command for this will be:

```
SELECT * FROM TABLE NAME;
```

Here, TABLE NAME represents the name of the table from where the data will be retrieved.

This is a basic command in MySQL that directs the script to select all the records in the table. As this command outputs a data, it should be placed with the results given to a variable.

```
$query="SELECT * FROM TABLE NAME";
$result=mysql_query($query);
```

The entire content of the table will be stored in the array \$result.

Retrieving data is also recognised with the term SELECT. The SELECT statement indicates selecting data from a database. See the following syntax:

```
SELECT column_name(s) FROM TABLE NAME;
```

Reconciling the statement above, we can use the mysql_query() function. With this function, a query or a command can be sent to a MySQL connection.

Example:

```
<?php
$con=mysql_connect("localhost","root");
mysql_select_db("ourdatabase",$con) or die("can
not select database or database does exist");
$select_query="SELECT * FROM ourtable";
$list = mysql_query($select_query);
while($record = mysql_fetch_array($list))
{
    echo $record['roll'] . " " . $record['name'] . "
".$record['address'] . " " . $record['ph_no'] . " "
.$record['grade'];
    echo "<br />";
}
```